

ACCESS ALLOCATION POLICY

Revision: 1.0

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Revision History

#	Version	Release Date	Description of the Change	Created/ Modified by	Approved by
1	1.0	16-May-2024	Initial	Kalpana J	Gayathri
2	1.1	08-Jan-2025	Updated privilege access request details	Krishnan S	Gayathri

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1. Purpose

This policy defines the guidelines and procedures for granting and removing system access for employees, contractors, and third-party vendors in order to ensure proper data security, compliance, and efficiency in the organization's IT infrastructure. This policy aims to protect sensitive company data and systems by ensuring that only authorized personnel have access to the resources required for their roles.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all users who require access to the organization's IT systems, applications, and data, including:

- Employees
- Contractors
- Third-party vendors
- Temporary workers

This policy applies to all software, systems, databases, and platforms used by the organization, including on-premise and cloud-based systems.

3. Roles and Responsibilities

3.1 Information Security Team (IS Team)

- Maintain and enforce the Access Allocation and Deallocation Policy.
- Review user access requests and ensure that only necessary access is granted.
- Conduct regular audits to verify access controls and remove unnecessary or outdated access.

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- Ensure compliance with relevant data protection laws, such as the Information Technology (Reasonable Security Practices and Procedures and Sensitive Personal Data or Information) Rules, 2011 and GDPR (if applicable).

3.2 IT/Systems Administrators

- Implement and manage access controls for all systems and applications.
- Create user accounts and assign appropriate access permissions based on role requirements.
- Deallocate or revoke access when an employee leaves the organization or no longer requires access.

3.3 Department Heads/Managers

- Approve access requests for employees in their respective departments.
- Ensure employees have access to only those systems necessary for their roles.

3.4 Employees and Contractors

- Ensure they follow security guidelines and best practices for password management and system access.
- Report any suspicious activity or security concerns to the IS team immediately.

4. Access Allocation Process

4.1 Access Request Initiation

- Access to any system or platform is granted based on a request initiated by the department head or manager.
- The request for new user access must be submitted through a formal access request form or an automated access management system.

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- The access request must include the following details:
 - Name of the individual
 - Department/Team
 - Purpose of access
 - Specific systems and data required for access
 - Duration of access (temporary or permanent)

4.2 Access Review and Approval

- The department head or manager must review the request to ensure that the access level is appropriate for the employee's role.
- The Information Security Team (IS Team) will validate the request for compliance with security policies.
- Upon approval, the access request is forwarded to the IT/Systems Administrators for implementation.

4.3 User Access Creation

- IT/Systems Administrators will create user accounts with the least privilege principle, meaning that the user will be given only the minimum necessary access for their role.
- Multi-factor authentication (MFA) should be enabled wherever possible to enhance security.
- Access credentials (usernames, passwords, etc.) will be securely communicated to the user.

4.4 Privileged Access Allocation

Privileged access refers to the rights granted to users for performing administrative or configuration tasks within critical systems. This process involves additional safeguards:

- 1. Privileged Access Request:** Any request for privileged access must include a clear business justification and be reviewed by the system owner, IT security, and senior management.
- 2. Escalation and Authorization:** Privileged access rights (e.g., system administrator, database administrator) must be approved by senior management and, where applicable, require dual approval.
- 3. Use of Privileged Access:** Access should be used strictly for the purpose for which it was granted. Privileged accounts must have logging and auditing enabled.
- 4. Privileged Account Monitoring:** Privileged access will be actively monitored using automated tools to detect suspicious activities and unauthorized usage.

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4.5 Documentation and Record Keeping

- All access requests and approvals should be documented and stored securely for audit purposes.
- A record of all user accounts, access levels, and permissions will be maintained by the IT department.

5. Access Deallocation Process

5.1 Deallocation Trigger Events

User access should be revoked or modified in the following situations:

5.1 Employee termination or resignation

- Change in job role or responsibilities (e.g., promotion, transfer)
- Completion of contract or project for contractors/third-party vendors
- Unused or inactive accounts for an extended period (e.g., 30+ days)
- Security incidents or breach of policies

5.2 Access Revocation Process

- The department head or manager must notify the IT/Systems Administrators immediately upon the occurrence of any of the above events.
- The IT/Systems Administrators will disable or delete user accounts in a timely manner, ensuring access to all systems, platforms, and applications is revoked.
- For contractors or third-party vendors, IT will ensure that access is terminated at the end of the engagement.

5.3 Removal of Access Permissions

- Access permissions will be reviewed periodically (quarterly or bi-annually) to identify inactive accounts or users with excess permissions.
- Any access that is deemed unnecessary or inappropriate will be promptly revoked by the IT team.
- Documentation of access deallocation must be updated to reflect these changes.

6. Periodic Review and Audit

6.1 Access Review

- A quarterly or semi-annual review of user access permissions should be conducted by the Information Security Team.
- This review will verify that access rights are still appropriate

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for the user's role and identify any deviations from the policy.

- Any discrepancies found will be addressed immediately, including revoking any unauthorized access.

6.2 Audit Logs

- All access allocations and deallocations should be logged in an audit trail.
- These logs will be retained for a minimum of 1 year for compliance purposes.
- Audit logs should be regularly reviewed to detect any unauthorized access attempts.

7. Security Requirements

- All users must comply with the organization's security policies, including strong password policies, two-factor authentication, and confidentiality agreements.
- Users must report any security incidents or suspicious activity to the IT department promptly.
- Access must be protected by strong, complex passwords and, where possible, multi-factor authentication (MFA).

8. Compliance and Legal Requirements

This policy adheres to all relevant Indian data protection and IT security laws, including:

- **The Information Technology (Reasonable Security Practices and Procedures and Sensitive Personal Data or Information) Rules, 2011**
- **The Personal Data Protection Bill** (when enacted)
- **ISO 27001** and other relevant cybersecurity standards

Access allocation and deallocation practices will also comply with any relevant client-specific security requirements.

9. Policy Violations

Violations of this policy, such as unauthorized access to systems or data, mishandling of sensitive information, or failure to follow access deallocation procedures, will result in disciplinary actions. Depending on the severity of the violation, actions may include:

- Reprimands or warnings

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- Suspension of system access
- Termination of employment or contracts
- Legal action, if applicable

10. Policy Review

This policy will be reviewed annually by the Information Security Team to ensure that it remains up to date with technological advancements, regulatory changes, and industry best practices.

11. Approval and Implementation

This policy will be implemented across the organization following approval from senior management and the Information Security Team. Training on the policy will be provided to all relevant stakeholders to ensure compliance.
